

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

BASIC EDUCATION CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION -- JUNE 2008

SOCIAL STUDIES -- PAPER 2

Duration: 1 Hour | Level: JHS 3 / BECE | Code: SOC 01/02 - P2

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Answer three questions in all, choosing one question from each of Sections I, II and III.

PART II: ESSAY & STRUCTURED QUESTIONS WITH WAEC RUBRICS

QUESTION 1: Section I: The Environment

Water bodies and natural resources across West Africa are under severe threat from human activities.

(a) Define the term "Environmental Degradation". [4 marks]

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: Environmental degradation is the deterioration of the environment through the depletion of resources such as air, water and soil, the destruction of ecosystems and the extinction of wildlife. [A4]

(b) Explain four negative effects of illegal mining (galamsey) on the socio-economic life of Ghanaians. [16 marks]

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: 1. Pollution of rivers and potable water sources increasing water treatment costs. 2. Destruction of vast cocoa and food crop farmlands leading to food insecurity. 3. Destruction of forest reserves and biodiversity. 4. High incidence of school dropouts and child labour in mining enclaves. [A4, B4, M4, A4]

QUESTION 2: Section II: Governance and Politics

Ghana adopted democratic governance under the Fourth Republic.

(a) State four fundamental human rights guaranteed under the 1992 Constitution of Ghana. [8 marks]

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: 1. Right to life. 2. Right to personal liberty and dignity. 3. Freedom of speech and expression. 4. Freedom of assembly and association. [B8]

(b) Describe three responsibilities of a good Ghanaian citizen. [12 marks]

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: 1. Prompt payment of taxes and rates to government. 2. Obeying the laws of the state and protecting public property. 3. Participating actively in democratic processes like voting and defending the nation. [A4, B4, M4]